



Ford invest 11.4B in e-vehicles

Ford jolts auto industry with \$11.4 billion investment in new electric vehicle, battery plants. <https://digit.in/oct21-45>



Imgur sold

Imgur has been bought by the owner of Kik, Genius, and WorldStarHipHop. <https://digit.in/oct21-46>

Networking for work

Agent001 gets into enterprise networking gear

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W

ith offices slowly opening up after having been closed for what seems to be like a decade, we're

all slowly coming to terms with how things have changed. Offices, like many businesses, were frozen in time since the country went into lockdown and even though 1.5 years doesn't seem like a long time, it certainly seems to have made offices feel like caves from the Stone Age. I'm specifically talking about the office networking infrastructure.

Lockdown forced a lot of us to convert our homes into makeshift offices and while the impact of this home-office model varies vastly from person-to-person and from company-to-company, a lot of us ended up upgrading our internet services. I for one, ended up spoiling myself with a nice enterprise setup that had a fully configurable gateway, switches and multiple access points which could be placed around the house to achieve networking nirvana i.e. a home without any Wi-Fi dead spots. And the shift to a 1 Gbps internet plan just made working from home even better.

It was natural that once we started working from the office that we'd be a little irked by the stark difference in the signal reception and bandwidth between working from home against what we ... *sigh* ... suffered through at work before the

become problems once we get back to working from our offices. And when you consider the fact that you will be sharing the network infrastructure with close to 200 people, you quickly realise how mind-numbing the experience will be.

Take our example, we've got multiple offices across the country with the largest one hosting 80 employees. That's 80 people working on the same infrastructure on a proper working day. Roughly half of those have desktops so they're wired to the network switches, the remaining 40 are dependent on the Wi-Fi routers. And all 80 would end up connecting their smartphones to the Wi-Fi as well. So we're looking at 120 actively connected devices or 'clients'



Bringing out the big guns

pandemic. We really haven't had to share our internet plans with 50-100 other individuals, we didn't have to ask the IT Admin before downloading a massive file, we rarely had to worry about data caps running out and most of us didn't have to worry about the wireless routers giving out. All of these things

during peak working hours. If each client is to be assigned about 100 Mbps worth of bandwidth, which is a far cry from the 1 Gbps that some of us have not gotten used to, then we're looking at 12,000 Mbps worth of bandwidth to ensure fairness for all.

12,000 might seem like a lot and some of you might try to equate that